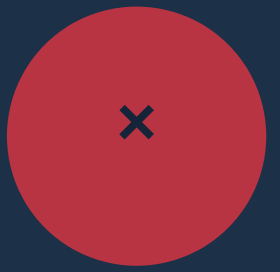

Love was never part of the deal.
THE TERMS OF ENGAGEMENT
THE TERMS
No falling in love.
NCCA ENTERTAINMENT
WRITTEN BY KELLY R. TENNEY

The only honest thing is the fake romance.

When a hot mic catches two rival political strategists trashing their own candidates, their bosses rebrand the scandal as a secret romance and stage an engagement through Election Day.

As their signed contract threatens to leak, the relationship they are faking becomes the only honest thing either has done in a decade.



RIVALS TO FIANCÉS

Original feature
Political romantic comedy

Eleven years of rivalry. One career-saving lie.

01

THE SCANDAL

A green-room recording costs both strategists their jobs.

02

THE SPIN

A focus group sees chemistry. Their bosses sell America a secret couple.

03

THE TRAP

The engagement restores access, then makes every private choice a public event.

The clock runs out on Election Night.

The terms are simple. Keeping them is impossible.

TERMS OF ENGAGEMENT

01 Public appearances only.
02 No kissing on the mouth.
03 Ends on Election Night.
04 No falling in love.

She writes the rules to stay in control.

He signs because he always performs.

Neither knows how to stop.

Two professionals. Two kinds of armor.

ALEX CHASE | 33

Democratic strategist. Dayton union roots.

Wants to protect the jobs bill she wrote. Defines every clause so nobody can ask for too much.

Her arc: from control to trust.

MARCUS THORNE | 35

Republican strategist. Georgia political dynasty.

Wants his father’s approval. Charms on cue and touches a cufflink when he lies.

His arc: from performance to conviction.

Love has a constituency. So does the lie.

THE CHASE FAMILY

Rose asks the plain questions Washington avoids.

Mother Pearl lends Marcus a union pin, and leaves Alex a legacy of love.

THE THORNE FAMILY

Calvin turns his son’s future into a campaign strategy.

Vivian’s heirloom ring quietly makes the engagement personal.

THE MACHINE

Dana and Gil convert intimacy into a message.

Priya’s mistake and Kara’s reporting bring the signed terms into daylight.

From damage control to a costly truth.

I

THE PERFORMANCE

Fired rivals become a staged couple. A truthful meet-cute slips into their rehearsed story.

II

THE REAL THING

Donor dinners and family visits deepen the bond. At Pearl’s funeral, Marcus chooses Alex over a $3M fundraiser.

III

THE RECKONING

The contract leaks. Each is offered a comeback by blaming the other. Both choose the truth.

The scenes audiences will remember.

HOT MIC

Weaponized banter becomes a career-ending recording.

THE DINNER

A Georgetown donor table turns into a chess match.

THE FUNERAL

Marcus stands beside Alex with nothing to gain.

THE PAUSE

On live television, he stops performing and owns the lie.

Fast dialogue. Quiet devastation. An earned sunrise.



SATIRICAL BITE

Quick, precise, competitive dialogue. Politics played through people and power.

ROMANTIC INTIMACY

Glances, tells, pauses, and the moment someone shows up without a deal.

Public polish gives way to private warmth.

Three cities. Three versions of belonging.

WASHINGTON, D.C.

THE IMAGE

Studios, green rooms, donor tables. Every moment can become a message.

DAYTON, OHIO

THE ROOTS

A union family, a factory, a church, and a porch where nobody buys the spin.

ATLANTA, GEORGIA

THE INHERITANCE

A political dynasty and the Fox Theatre’s painted sky. A future Marcus must choose.

A ring. A pin. A tell. A real sky.

R

THE RING

Family makes the lie feel real.

P

THE UNION PIN

Trust is placed in his hands.

C

THE CUFFLINK

Charm gives away the truth.

S

THE SUNRISE

An honest future, still unwritten.

A familiar romantic engine. A specific new world.

LONG SHOT

Political friction and romantic-comedy momentum.

RED, WHITE & ROYAL BLUE

Public duty colliding with private desire.

INSECURE

The emotional register of Black ambition, intimacy, and vulnerability.

VEEP

The language, pressure, and absurdity of the political machine.

For viewers who want chemistry, sharp comedy, and emotional consequences.

CASTING VISION

Two leads who can win the argument and hold the silence.

DREAM PAIRING

Ayo Edebiri as Alex Chase
Regé-Jean Page as Marcus Thorne

Precision comedy meets a polished romantic lead.

ALTERNATE PAIRING

Keke Palmer as Alex Chase
Damson Idris as Marcus Thorne

Rapid-fire energy and a more combustible rivalry.

Additional lead options: Zazie Beetz / Corey Hawkins

Casting wish list only. No talent attached or availability confirmed.

An ensemble with authority, wit, and warmth.

Calvin Thorne	**Courtney B. Vance**
Vivian Thorne	**Angela Bassett**
Rose Chase	**Niecy Nash-Betts**
Mother Pearl Chase	**Leslie Uggams**
Dana Whitmore	**Allison Janney**
Gil Brannigan	**Walton Goggins**
Priya Raman	**Maitreyi Ramakrishnan**

Wish list only. Availability, interest, and quotes have not been confirmed.

A clear streaming pitch with a theatrical heart.

NETFLIX

Proposed platform target

A high-concept romance about public performance and private truth, centered on two Black professionals and two distinct American families.

$30M–$55M

Indicative budget tier

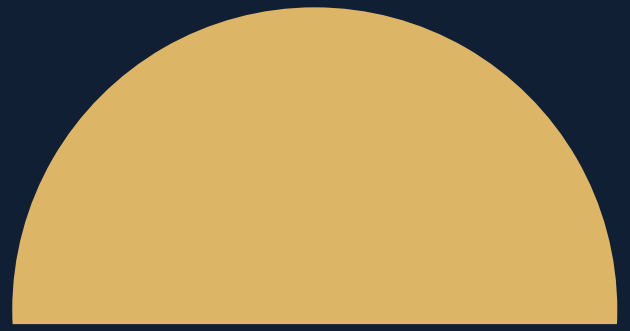
Two central leads. Dialogue-driven ensemble. Three story settings.

Original feature • Budget and production scope subject to validation

The promise: still disagreeing, finally honest.

Alex tells the truth before she knows whether Marcus will choose her.

Marcus takes the pause his father taught him never to take, and walks away from the future chosen for him.



A REAL SUNRISE

Love becomes a choice they can make without a contract.

Love was never part of the deal.

THE TERMS OF ENGAGEMENT

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